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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

In retail, tourism, biotechnology, health care, and other sectors, Harvard University is a vital component.

On ‘common’ but rocky ground

Garber says Harvard backs some priorities of Trump but decries tactics

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — In the midst of his extraordinary standoff with the federal government, Harvard president Alan Garber said Monday that his university shares some “common ground” with the Trump administration.

In a letter to Secretary of Education Linda McMahon, he agreed that combatting antisemitism and making Harvard more open to a wide range of viewpoints were worthy priorities. But he denounced the Trump administration’s methods for addressing those issues as counterproductive and “unlawful” and said Harvard is reforming itself without government intervention.

“Harvard’s efforts to achieve these goals are undermined and threatened by the federal government’s overreach into the constitutional freedoms of private universities,” he wrote in response to McMahon’s letter last week announcing that Harvard would no longer be eligible for new federal grants.

The exchange of letters between the top education official in the US government and the leader of the country’s most prestigious and wealthiest university is the latest episode in the Trump administration’s campaign against elite universities.

The government has alleged that Harvard and other schools have allowed antisemitism to fester and cultivated an environment where conservative viewpoints are reviled. The Trump administration has threatened to cut off billions of dollars in federal research funding if universities do not reorient themselves ideologically, clamp down on pro-Palestinian protests, and take wide-ranging measures — including changing admissions practices and overhauling certain academic programs — that government officials say would help suppress campus antisemitism.

Last month, Harvard sued the federal government over a \$2.2 billion funding freeze meant as punishment for the university’s refusal to comply with the government’s demands.

HARVARD, Page A10



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Harvard owns extensive land and properties on both sides of the Charles River including the four-building Enterprise Research Campus on Western Avenue.

From tech sector to tourism, a bedrock of Mass. economy

University helps propel region’s growth in ways subtle and substantial

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

In ways big and small, money loops through the ornate gates of Harvard University into Cambridge and beyond.

Students buy romance novels at Love-struck Books and \$5 Narragansetts at Charlie’s Kitchen. Postdoctoral researchers pay for groceries with paychecks from Harvard labs. Professors buy homes with university-backed mortgages. Tourists fly across the globe to rub John Harvard’s

foot. And startups are born in quiet classrooms.

Harvard is the point of origin for hundreds of successful companies, a magnet for ambitious people, and a crucial piece of the innovation economy that has powered Massachusetts’ growth in recent decades.

Now much of that ecosystem feels at risk. As the Trump administration pressures Harvard to rework everything from admissions to academics, threatening billions in federal funding, the prosperity of Boston itself is in the crosshairs.

“We’re all just holding our breath figuring out where the impact is coming,” said Denise Jillson, executive director of the Harvard Square Business Association. “We

ECONOMY, Page A10

US, China to suspend triple-digit tariffs

Temporary reprieve comes with no concessions as both sides vow more talks

By Daisuke Wakabayashi
and Amy Chang Chien

NEW YORK TIMES

The United States and China took a step Monday to defuse the trade war between the world’s two largest economies, agreeing to temporarily reduce the punishing tariffs they have imposed on each other.

The move by the United States, after President Trump had repeatedly declared he would not lower tariffs without concessions from China, represented an acknowledgment of the costs of an all-out trade war with China. Despite the White House’s bluster, the Trump administration backed off, for now, from its steepest tariffs and agreed to hold more formal talks with Beijing after companies and consumers started showing signs of economic strain.

Explaining that many of the tariffs he imposed remain in place, Trump said at the White House on Monday talks would be focused in part on “opening up” China to American businesses. He said he expected to talk to President Xi Jinping of China this week but putting a full deal on paper would take a while.

“We’re not looking to hurt China,” Trump said.

In a joint statement released earlier in the day, the United States and China said they would sus-

TARIFFS, Page A7

MGB to invest \$400m in primary care

But health care giant light on details amid union vote

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Mass General Brigham on Monday pledged to invest nearly \$400 million over the next five years to enhance primary care, citing a nationwide shortage of doctors, physician burnout, and demand for care outstripping resources.

Dr. Anne Klibanski, chief executive of the state’s largest health care system, announced the investment, which she called “unprecedented,” in an e-mail to employees, even as hundreds of primary care doctors at MGB vote this month on whether to join a union.

“In order to support our people so they can care for our patients, we must elevate primary care in our system,” Klibanski wrote.

MGB said the money will pay for more than 90 new support staffers and four more doctors. It will also provide more support for “practices that serve highly complex patients, patients with social needs, and our aging population,” Klibanski wrote.

PRIMARY CARE, Page A6



Rays; an objection

Tuesday: Sunny, cooler.
High 60-65, low 47-52.

Wednesday: Showers late.
High 62-67, low 54-59.

Sunrise: 5:25. Sunset: 7:57.

Weather and comics, **D5-6**.
Obituaries, **C9**.

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Edan Alexander, the last living American hostage Hamas held in the Gaza Strip, is free, in a deal that largely bypassed Israel. A4.

House Republicans proposed a sweeping budget that would pay for tax breaks by changing the eligibility and rules for Medicaid and cutting green energy programs. A2.

Those who most need new weight loss drugs might not get them

By Jonathan Saltzman and Scooty Nickerson
GLOBE STAFF

They’re among the hottest-selling drugs in the country. Celebrities who say the blockbuster medicines known as GLP-1s helped them to shed weight include Whoopi Goldberg, Charles Barkley, and Elon Musk.

But in Massachusetts, as elsewhere in the country, the people who would benefit most from these drugs may not be getting them, according to a Globe analysis of data compiled by Real Chemistry, a global health analytics firm, and statistics from the US Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

Obesity, which afflicts about 40 percent of US adults, is more common among low-income residents and Black and Hispanic people than other ethnic and socio-economic groups. But the Globe analysis found that patients taking

WEIGHT LOSS, Page A6

PAINFUL LOSS FOR CELTICS



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Celtics fell to the Knicks 121-113 in Game 4 of the NBA Eastern Conference semifinal at Madison Square Garden in New York. The Celtics, now down 3-1 in the series, also lost forward Jayson Tatum, who was injured late in the game. **C1.**